

QUALITY OF SLEEP | EXERCISE 1

Quality of Sleep

Individual Exercise

1

Complete the Quality of Sleep Individual Assessment PDF.

2

Answer the questions one by one by selecting one of the options and ticking the box provided.

3

Take time to reflect on each question and answer as honestly as you can.

4

Refer to the Best Practice Principles provided with this worksheet and select 2-3 key components to incorporate into your life to improve your Sleep Quality.

QUALITY OF SLEEP | EXERCISE 1

Individual Assessment | Quality of Sleep

Do you have a regular sleep routine?

Yes

No

On average how many hours sleep/night do you get?

<5

5-6

7

8

9

How long does it take you to fall asleep?

<10 mins

10-15 mins

15-20 mins

20-30 mins

More than 30 mins

How often do you wake up during the night?

never

1 time

2 times

3 times

More than 3 times

How often does it take you more than 20 mins to go back to sleep?

never

sometimes

regularly

always

How often do you feel tired during the day?

never

sometimes

regularly

every day

How often do you snack on junk food when you are tired?

never

sometimes

regularly

every day

How often do you drink caffeine/energy drinks to stay alert?

never

sometimes

regularly

every day

If you work late, do you delay going to bed after your normal time?

never

sometimes

regularly

always

When is the last time you check work emails in the evening?

6pm

7pm

8pm

9pm

Later than 9pm

Do you do vigorous exercise less than 1 hour before bed?

never

sometimes

regularly

every day

How often do you eat less than 3 hours before going to bed?

never

sometimes

regularly

every day

When do you stop using electronic devices in the evening (TV, laptop, phone)?

More than 1 hr before sleep

1 hr before sleep

30 mins before sleep

just before sleep

How would you rate your sleep environment (bed, light, noise, temperature)?

very poor

poor

neutral

good

very good

QUALITY OF SLEEP | BEST PRACTICE

Improving Sleep Quality - Best Practice

Enhance your resilience by incorporating these sleep hygiene habits:

1. Reinforce your circadian rhythm with a regular sleep pattern of 7-9 hours.
2. Early bird, or night owl? Understand and adapt to your chronotype - do focus work when most alert / go to bed when tired, to improve sleep quality, energy, mood, performance.
3. Night owls may have trouble sleeping, so try shifting your circadian rhythm earlier. Consistently exercising at 7am and good sleep hygiene has been shown to shift circadian rhythm.
4. Walk outside within an hour of waking, daylight synchronises your circadian rhythm.
5. Deep Sleep and REM are improved by daily fresh air and exercise. They are critical to creativity, memory, learning, insightful thinking, and protection against dementia.
6. Incorporate daily physical activity to improve sleep quality including 7,000 steps/day preferably outside, evening relaxing exercise e.g. yoga, to increase REM, Deep Sleep, and melatonin (primary sleep hormone).
7. Limit naps to 20 minutes and eat protein at lunchtime to avoid an energy slump.
8. Create a bedtime routine to relax your mind and body, such as journalling, meditation, reading, breathing exercises or a warm bath.
9. Good Nutrition helps quality sleep:-
 - have your last meal at least 3 hours before going to bed to allow your body time to process it.
 - avoid alcohol and caffeine sources such as chocolate, tea, coffee, and soda from 5pm or earlier. These can cause interrupted sleep and reduce deep sleep.
 - Increase melatonin production with probiotics such as kefir, eat tryptophan-rich foods (turkey, nuts, seeds).
 - Choose relaxing exercise not vigorous exercise <60 mins before bed.
10. Make your bedroom as comfortable as possible, at the right temperature (c. 65F/18C). Reduce light and sound using black-out curtains, eye mask, ear plugs, or white-noise devices.
11. Switch off electronic devices 30-60 mins before bed, they emit blue light which inhibits the production of melatonin.
12. If you can't fall asleep within 30 minutes, get up and leave the bedroom. Read or do another quiet activity for 15 to 20 minutes until you get sleepy.